

7 Updating profile pages

The profile page of Facebook provides a snapshot of who a user is and what he/she finds important. A Facebook application can add profile boxes, application tabs and info sections to manipulate this information.

7.1 Profile boxes

The Profile boxes are FBML based and do not allow profiles to use IFrames or Flash. The content is set by the application using the `profile.setFBML()` API call. There are three types of Profile Boxes in Facebook, namely Main, Wide and Narrow. The Main box appears on the left side of the Wall and the Info tab of a profile, and measures 184x250 pixels. A maximum of four of these appear at a time on the Profile page, and the rest are moved to the Boxes tab. The Narrow and Wide boxes appear on the Boxes tab by default. Wide appears on the left side and is 380 px wide, whereas the Narrow appears on the right and is 184px wide. Both of these don't have any height limitations. These profile boxes can be moved by the user by dragging and dropping, but the content inside a `<fb:narrow>` tagged box only shows up when the profile box is on the right side, while content in a `<fb:wide>` tagged box only shows up on the left side. A good profile box will support both the locations by displaying the content formatted appropriately based on size limitations.

The PHP client library has different parameters for the `profile_setFBML()` call:

Parameter	Details
markup	It has been deprecated. Just pass it as NULL.
Uid	This denotes the user ID for the user or Public Profile to update, which is set to the current user by default.
profile	It is a string parameter which contains the FBML for the profile box on the Boxes tab.
profile_action	It has been deprecated. Just pass it as NULL.
mobile_profile	It is a string parameter which contains the FBML that appears on http://m.facebook.com .
profile_main	It is a string parameter which contains the FBML that appears on the Main profile box.

Example:

```
$markup = NULL;  
$mainFBML = "Appears on the Wall";
```